

Before the OEI Diagnosis

Upfront prerequisites for the 4-day OEI Diagnosis record

To begin the Diagnosis, the Institute needs access to a small set of operational evidence and time with the people doing the work. Missing inputs can limit confidence in affected findings; any resulting limits are documented in the diagnostic report.

REQUIRED TO BEGIN

- **Communication history:** read access to the primary team communication tool (such as Slack or Teams), covering at least the most recent 30 days of operational channels.
- **Founder calendar:** access to the past two weeks, using a shared view or screenshots if needed.
- **Work tracking:** access to the task or project tool (such as Notion, Jira, Linear, or Asana) and all non-confidential operational boards.
- **Team interviews:** 30–45 minutes for 3–5 team members, scheduled in advance.
- **Founder intake:** a 60–90 minute session on Day 1.
- **Organization structure:** the current staff hierarchy or equivalent description.

STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

- Read access to the internal documentation system (such as Notion, Confluence, or Google Drive).
- A list of active tools and the primary function of each.
- A recent organization chart or a written description of reporting relationships.

USEFUL IF AVAILABLE

- Past sprint reports or retrospectives.
- Process documentation, including informal notes or working instructions.

Share only what is appropriate. Please identify confidential material and arrange the agreed access method with your OEI practitioner before sharing. Provide read-only access where it is sufficient.

What to expect

Four days of company contact; up to seven days for the complete cycle

“4-day OEI Diagnosis” refers to the four-day period of established contact with the company. The complete Diagnosis cycle can take up to seven days to include report drafting, delivery, and a debrief. Timing depends on access, evidence, scheduling, and other client inputs.

DIAGNOSIS SEQUENCE

STAGE	WORK
Day 0	Confirm access and schedule team interviews.
Day 1	Founder intake (60–90 minutes) and initial evidence review.
Days 2–3	Team interviews and operational system analysis.
Day 4	Complete company contact: synthesize evidence, draft findings, and conduct final validation.
Days 5–7	Complete the report: drafting, delivery, and debrief.

THE DIAGNOSIS RECORD

The first engagement milestone is the 4-day OEI Diagnosis record. It applies the Operational Entropy Index across its five dimensions: Founder Dependency, Knowledge Logistics, Workflow Velocity, Tool Discipline, and Handoff Integrity. The record presents evidence-based diagnostic findings; specific scope and depth depend on the engagement.

IF SOMETHING IS DELAYED OR UNAVAILABLE

Before the Diagnosis begins, delays caused by missing access, evidence, or other prerequisites are documented along with any resulting limits on confidence in affected findings. A pre-diagnosis delay does not automatically create a financial penalty or forfeiture. Coordinate with the Institute if an input is unavailable or if timing needs to change.

OEI INSTITUTE

The OEI Institute governs the Operational Entropy Index methodology and supports its application through OEI Native practitioners.